

Activity 2: Reading for specific information

Aims

To review the test format and also give learners useful skills practice in reading for specific information.

Level

Can be adapted for all levels.

Preparation

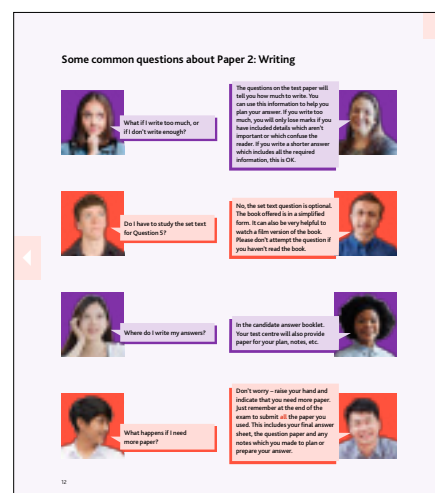
Go to the [Information for Candidates](#) booklet for the exam you are teaching. Use the information from the booklet and create a worksheet. Write eight to ten questions that require the learners to scan for specific information. Simple 'How long'/'How many' questions using the exam format sections (see image) work well for lower levels e.g.:

- How long is the Writing paper?
- How many parts are there to the Speaking paper?

You can use more sections of the booklet and add more complex questions for higher levels e.g.:

- How many parts of the Listening paper have only one speaker?
- What should you do if you can't hear the audio?

Make a copy of the parts of the booklet you want learners to look at. A fun option that also saves paper, is to create a treasure hunt and cut the booklet into different sections and stick these around the classroom so learners have to walk around to search for the answers.



Step 1

Hand out the worksheet with your questions on it and give learners time to read and think about what kind of information they need to look for.

Step 2

Set a time limit or make the activity a competition so that it encourages learners to read quickly. Start the activity.

When the time is up, you could get learners to write the answers on the board and check them together.

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Alternative or follow-up activities to consider

- Create listening comprehension tasks using the Speaking test videos.
- The Information for Candidates booklets already include common questions and answers. Learners can compare what they already know in pairs before they read the text to find out more.
- Learners use the exam-day information to make their own exam-day checklist.
- Learners can use the Information for Candidates booklet to prepare quizzes for each other in groups.
- Use an online quiz maker like [Kahoot](#) to make a quiz about the test format. First-time Kahoot users can go [here](#) for a tutorial.

Paper 1: Reading and Use of English

	Parts 1-3	Three short texts (one text for each part), with different tasks. You must complete the gaps with different kinds of words.
1 hour 15 minutes	Part 4	No text. You must rewrite sentences in a different way.
7 parts	Part 5	One long text with six multiple-choice questions.
	Part 6	One text with six gaps. You must choose the correct sentence for each gap.
	Part 7	One text or several short texts, with 10 questions. You must match each question to something in the text(s).

1 There are many different types of text in the exam: newspaper and magazine articles, reports, fiction, advertisements, letters, messages and informational material (such as brochures, guides, manuals, etc.). They're all about topics which are interesting to teenage students. Before you take the exam, it's important that you have seen these kinds of text before and that you know how to do the kind of tasks which appear in the exam.

Extra help online
You can find a [sample test and self-study lesson plans on our website](#) to practice different parts of the Reading and Use of English paper.

★ To improve your reading skills, it's really important to read many different types of text which you really enjoy. If you have a special interest or hobby, try reading about it in English as much as you can. You can read anything: blogs, books, magazine articles, social media, informational websites or encyclopaedias. The important thing is just to read as much as possible and to enjoy it!

For this paper you need to study things like collocations (words which often go together), phrasal verbs, linking words and to understand how writers use different words to express similar meanings. (All of these are important for the Writing paper, too!) When you're preparing for the exam, keep a notebook and write down vocabulary which you see often. You could use this to test yourself later.